

Introduction to Limits



Evaluating limits

- 1 Evaluate $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2} \frac{x^2 - 4}{x - 2}$ by first simplifying the expression.
- 2 Evaluate by direct substitution where possible:
 - a $\lim_{x \rightarrow 3} (x^2 + 2x - 1)$
 - b $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{x+5}{x+1}$
- 3 Using a table of values near $x = 0$ (in radians), estimate $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sin x}{x}$.

One-sided limits and limits at infinity

- 4 Let $f(x) = \frac{|x|}{x}$. Find:
 - a $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} f(x)$
 - b $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^-} f(x)$
 - c $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} f(x)$
- 5 Evaluate each limit at infinity:
 - a $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{3x^2 + 5}{x^2 - 2}$
 - b $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{2x+1}{x^2 + 4}$
- 6 The graph of $f(x) = \frac{1}{x-2} + 3$ has asymptotes $x = 2$ and $y = 3$. Express each asymptote as a limit statement.

More limit computations

- 7 Evaluate $\lim_{x \rightarrow 4} \frac{\sqrt{x}-2}{x-4}$ by rationalizing the numerator.
- 8 Evaluate $\lim_{x \rightarrow -1} \frac{x^3 + 1}{x + 1}$ by factoring (using the sum-of-cubes formula).
- 9 Evaluate $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\tan x}{x}$, using $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sin x}{x} = 1$ and $\tan x = \frac{\sin x}{\cos x}$.

Continuity and limits together

- 10 A function f is defined by $f(x) = x + 3$ for $x \neq 2$, and $f(2) = 10$. Find $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2} f(x)$ and state whether f is continuous at $x = 2$.
- 11 Estimate $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} (\sqrt{x^2 + 1} - x)$ by rationalizing.

Limits from graphs and tables

- 12** A function g satisfies $g(1.9) = 5.8$, $g(1.99) = 5.98$, $g(1.999) = 5.998$, $g(2.1) = 6.2$, $g(2.01) = 6.02$, $g(2.001) = 6.002$. Based on this table, estimate $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2} g(x)$.
- 13** Explain, using one-sided limits, why $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{1}{x^2}$ exists as an infinite limit (both one-sided limits agree), while $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{1}{x}$ does not exist even as an infinite limit.